Introductory Programming

(4CS001)

Coding Challenge

(Caesar Cipher)

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1. What are the most challenging aspect of the coursework task?

The most challenging aspect of the coursework task was to write the code following all the instructions strictly. We had to make different functions like the welcome function to welcome the users, enter message to get users' input if they want to encrypt or decrypt the text, encrypt function to encrypt the given text, and decrypt function to decrypt the text. And lastly, call all of the functions in the main function. And also if the users entered a string containing z or a, we had to make increase and decrease the shifted number by 26 respectively. And we also had to follow the official guide named the PEP8.

2. How did you go about completing the task?

First I read all the instructions very carefully and I noted them down. The noted the things that I had to include in the program. Then I made a rough framework of the code. Then I watched some videos related to Caesar cipher on Youtube and they helped a lot. Following that, I began to code. First I wrote code to take all the necessary inputs. Then I made functions for each of them. There was a little problem, if the text contained z or a then other characters would print instead of alphabets so it took a while to solve it.

3. What have you learned over the course of completing this coursework task?

While doing this coursework, one of the challenging parts for me was to make various functions. I did not have a clear understanding of using functions, passing parameters, and returning their value. But in the coursework, it was strictly mentioned to make functions so I had to learn about it in detail. I finally understood it after running into several mistakes and correcting them. It was not as difficult as it was in Java. And I also learned how to use for loop in python. I also learned some new methods like chr() to convert ascii value into character and ord() to convert a character into its respected asci value.